

Before the enquiry

Ten checks the studio runs on every website for firms that design and build houses.

Tick each one your website passes. Be honest; nobody else sees this.

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- ☐ 01 **The first screen says what you make and where.**
- GOOD In five seconds a stranger knows the kind of work you do and the part of the country you do it in.
- IF NOT They go back to the search results and click the next firm.
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- ☐ 02 **Your best project is one click from the homepage.**
- GOOD The strongest house leads, reachable without scrolling through a grid.
- IF NOT Visitors judge you on whatever loads first, which is often an older job.
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- ☐ 03 **Project pages tell the story of the house.**
- GOOD The brief and the decision that shaped the house come first, then the photographs.
- IF NOT Forty images with no words read as a gallery, not as a firm with judgement.
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- ☐ 04 **Photographs are large and load quickly.**
- GOOD Professional photography at full width, compressed so a page opens in about two seconds on a phone.
- IF NOT On a weak signal the visitor leaves before the first image appears.
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- ☐ 05 **It works properly on a phone.**
- GOOD Text you can read without zooming and links big enough to tap.
- IF NOT Referrals often arrive as a link in a message, so the phone is the first impression.
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- ☐ 06 **The next step is on every page.**
- GOOD A short link that starts with a verb, such as "Begin a conversation", at the end of every page.
- IF NOT Interested visitors have to hunt for the contact page, and some stop looking.
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- ☐ 07 **The enquiry form asks for very little.**
- GOOD Name, email, a line about the project and a note on when you will reply.
- IF NOT Every extra field loses a few people who were ready to write.
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- ☐ 08 **Proof sits near the ask.**
- GOOD Credits for the architect or builder you worked with and a client's own words, close to the contact link.
- IF NOT Someone about to commit a large budget wants reassurance at the moment they decide.
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- ☐ 09 **Where you work is stated plainly.**
- GOOD The counties or cities you take on, written as words rather than hidden in an image or a map.
- IF NOT Enquiries from outside your area waste time, and the ones inside it struggle to find you.
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- ☐ 10 **It looks current.**
- GOOD A project from the last twelve months and this year in the footer.
- IF NOT A site that looks left alone makes people wonder whether the firm still trades.
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Three or more unticked is where your enquiries are going. The Website Week fixes all ten in one week.